TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT · E2A

# Personal Mentor Course Workbook

Your workbook for the Province's Personal Mentor course. Bring it to the session, write in it, and keep it: the exercises are the ones you will use with your mentee.

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| **Participant** | Name: _____ Lodge: _____ |
| **Delivered by** | W Bro Wes Pierce, Deputy Provincial Grand Mentor · Issue 1, October 2026 |

## 1 The story of a man we lost

> "I joined at thirty-four, proposed by a colleague I liked. My Initiation was extraordinary; I drove home buzzing. Then came my second meeting: nobody had told me it was mainly business, and I sat at dinner next to two men who talked across me all night about people I didn't know. At my first rehearsal evening I was told after ten minutes there was nothing for me and I should get off home. Work went mad that spring; I missed two meetings. Nobody rang. When I came back, someone at the bar said, 'Well, look who's remembered where we meet.' Everyone laughed. I laughed too. My subscription renewal came in January with a letter that read like a final demand. I paid it, and then I sat down one Sunday and wrote a different letter. The Secretary's reply was very polite. It said my resignation had been received and would be reported to the Lodge. Nobody ever asked me why."

**Where were the moments this could have been turned around?** Mark them in the story and list them here.

## 2 What the role is, and is not

| Your role is | Your role is not |
|---|---|
| ■ His first point of contact for any question<br>■ Someone who keeps in touch between meetings<br>■ A listener who notices when something changes<br>■ His bridge to the Lodge and the Province | ■ The only person who can help him<br>■ A ritual coach; that is the Lodge of Instruction<br>■ Someone who monitors or reports on him<br>■ A replacement for the Lodge Mentor, who co-ordinates |

**The four principles.** Defined once in *The Hertfordshire Mentoring Principles*. They run together, all the time. They are not stages.

| 1 PREPARE | 2 GUIDE | 3 SUPPORT | 4 ENLIGHTEN |
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| Ready for each stage before it happens. No surprises. | Accurate, honest, timely information. Never dependency. | Present, responsive, compassionate. "How can we help?" | Understanding, curiosity and enjoyment, for life. |

**Coach, not counsellor.** If he tells you something that touches his health, money, family or safety, speak to the Lodge Almoner and the Lodge Mentor promptly. Referring early is the skill, not the failure.

## 3 Exercise 1: questions that open doors

A closed question invites a one-word answer. An open question invites the truth. Rewrite each of these so that you could not predict the answer.

| Closed | Your open version |
|---|---|
| "Did you enjoy the ceremony?" | |
| "Are you settling in alright?" | |
| "Have you got any questions?" | |
| "Are you coming to the next meeting?" | |
| "Is the ritual learning going okay?" | |
| "Everything alright at home?" | |

**Live practice, three minutes each way.** Ask your partner: *"What did you make of your own Initiation, all those years ago?"* Then listen. Note one thing he said that you would not have guessed.

## 4 Exercise 2: listening, and the three-second rule

> **The rule.** When silence falls, count to three before you speak. He will usually fill it, and what he says then is the real answer.
> **Listen for** tone, hesitation, what he returns to, and what he does not say.

Repeat the conversation from Exercise 1. This time the listener may say nothing except to ask one further question. Afterwards:

**What did you hear the second time that you missed the first?**

# 5 Exercise 3: scenarios

Your table takes one scenario. Ten minutes. What would you do **tonight, this week, this month**, and **who else needs to know**?

## Scenario A: The overwhelmed Entered Apprentice

> Your mentee, initiated two months ago, says at the Festive Board: "Honestly, I still haven't a clue what's going on in there. Everyone else seems to just know." He is smiling, but he has said it twice now.
>
> **What do you do tonight, this week, this month?**

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| **Tonight** | |
| **This week** | |
| **This month** | |
| **Who else needs to know** | |

## Scenario B: The quiet drift

> A Master Mason of three years, not your mentee but a man you know, has missed two consecutive meetings without apology. The Treasurer mentions his subscription is unpaid. He was passed over for Inner Guard last year.
>
> **Who acts, in what order, and what is said in the first phone call?**

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|---|---|
| **Tonight** | |
| **This week** | |
| **This month** | |
| **Who else needs to know** | |

## Scenario C: The ritual dread

> Your mentee has been offered his first office. He tells you privately he barely slept before his Second Degree questions and is thinking of saying no: "I'm just not a performer, and I think they'll think less of me."
>
> **What does good mentoring look like here, in both directions: to him, and to the Lodge?**

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|---|---|
| **Tonight** | |
| **This week** | |
| **This month** | |
| **Who else needs to know** | |

### Scenario D: The eager recruiter

> At the bar, a well-meaning senior Brother is pressing your recently raised mentee about joining the Chapter: "You're not a proper Mason till you've done it, you know. I'll put your name down." Your mentee looks cornered.
>
> **What do you do in the moment, and afterwards?**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Tonight** | |
| **This week** | |
| **This month** | |
| **Who else needs to know** | |

## 6 The warning signs and the four steps

Risk shows as a break in his own pattern, not as a low level of attendance. One sign is nothing. A pattern is a conversation.

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| **Attendance** | Two or more consecutive meetings missed without a word; attending only Installations or socials; a summer absence that runs into autumn. |
| **Participation** | Reluctance to accept work or office; withdrawal from conversation; missing the Lodge of Instruction while holding office; visible unhappiness. |
| **Communication** | Unanswered calls and messages; expressed frustration; repeated talk of time or money pressure; subscription arrears. |

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| **Step 1** | You. Friendly, informal contact after any unexpected absence. After two consecutive misses, within seven days of the second meeting. |
| **Step 2** | The Lodge Mentor. Takes the overview; asks what the Lodge itself could change; keeps a discreet note; closes the loop with the member. |
| **Step 3** | The Worshipful Master, with the Almoner alongside for anything touching welfare. |

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| **Step 4** | The Province. An impartial voice, or a different Lodge where he might thrive. Referral is responsible mentoring, not failure. |

> **The right question.** Always “How can I help?”, never “Why haven’t you been attending?”.

## 7 The tools, and where they live

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| **Personal Mentor’s Short Guide** | The role, the journey at a glance, the conversations that matter, help for you. Read it on the train. |
| **Mentor Meeting Guide** | A conversation guide for one-to-one meetings, stage by stage. Reach for it before each one-to-one. |
| **Stage Checklists** | One page each for Initiation night, the second meeting, before Passing and Raising, Installation and first LoI. |
| **Warning Signs card** | The signs and the four steps on one card for your pocket. |
| **Solomon** | UGLE’s learning platform: solomon.ugle.org.uk. Send him there, and go yourself. |
| **Monthly mentoring call** | First Tuesday of the month, 7pm, Teams. Bring questions. |
| **DAWG** | The Daily Advancement WhatsApp Group, run by the Provincial Mentoring Team. Ask to be added. |

## 8 My commitment

> **One thing I will do differently with my mentee this month:**

**By when:** _____ **I will know it worked when:**

_____

**Family, Work, Masonry: in that order, always.** Freemasonry must be fun. A man who is enjoying himself attends; a man who attends participates; a man who participates belongs; and a man who belongs does not resign. That is the whole job.

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